

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | SIEM/SOAR Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Senior Security Engineer with over five years of enterprise security operations and engineering experience, specialising in Microsoft Security platforms including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Defender for Identity (MDI). I have designed, built, and operationalised Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) capabilities using Kusto Query Language (KQL), building analytics rules, detection logic, and automated response playbooks for an 8,000-user estate. I have hands-on experience leading Microsoft Sentinel deployments, integrating data sources, tuning detection rules to reduce false positives, and developing executive and operational dashboards. I bring additional depth in CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), and identity governance in Entra ID and Azure Active Directory (AD), complemented by the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification. I am seeking a senior engineering role where I can lead complex Sentinel and Defender XDR implementations and drive security maturity in enterprise environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** KQL analytics rules, SOAR automation playbooks, data connector configuration, Log Analytics Workspace management, workbook and dashboard development, threat hunting queries
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365, Defender for Cloud Apps – deployment, policy configuration, incident investigation
- **SIEM/SOAR Engineering:** Detection rule development, correlation logic, alert tuning, playbook automation, SIEM integration with third-party data sources, use-case development aligned to MITRE ATT&CK
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Falcon Prevent (NG-AV), EDR, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM – Expert; endpoint policy management, real-time response, threat hunting
- **Identity & Access Management:** Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust PAM, privilege lifecycle governance
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure (Entra ID, Log Analytics, Sentinel, Defender for Cloud), cloud security posture management, Azure security configuration and hardening
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, threat hunting, root cause analysis, containment and recovery
- **Scripting & Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR logic apps and playbooks, workflow automation
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the design, deployment, and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform for UAL, integrating data connectors across Microsoft Defender XDR, Entra ID, and third-party sources.
- Author and maintain KQL analytics rules, detection logic, and SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, tuning alerting thresholds to reduce false positives while maintaining high-fidelity threat detection.
- Build and maintain operational dashboards and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel for SOC analysts and executive stakeholders, surfacing key security metrics and incident trends.
- Operate and mature Microsoft Defender XDR capabilities including Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Defender for Office 365, across an estate of 8,000+ users.

- Lead enterprise-level Microsoft Sentinel SIEM configuration from architecture through deployment and use-case tuning, integrating security signals from endpoint, identity, email, and network sources.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) for endpoint protection and threat detection across all managed endpoints.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hypotheses in both Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon, identifying indicators of compromise and lateral movement.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account governance, session recording, and least-privilege enforcement across administrative accounts.
- Configure and harden Entra ID / Azure AD environments, implementing Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies to support Zero Trust architecture principles.
- Mentor junior security analysts on SIEM detection engineering, KQL query development, and incident analysis best practices.
- Manage vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning findings to remediation SLAs and risk appetite.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Sentinel across the university estate, onboarding endpoints and configuring data connectors and baseline analytics policies.
- Developed KQL detection rules and SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage, enrich incidents with threat intelligence, and trigger response actions across integrated platforms.
- Triage and investigated security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Mimecast, escalating high-severity incidents and coordinating containment with infrastructure and identity teams.
- Built and maintained SIEM dashboards and reporting workbooks to track alert volume, incident trends, and SOC performance metrics for security management.
- Administered Check Point Harmony firewall policies and Tanium endpoint management, supporting network perimeter security and endpoint compliance reporting.
- Contributed to identity governance activities in Entra ID, managing role-based access control (RBAC), access reviews, and Conditional Access policy development.
- Participated in incident response under NIST 800-61, mapping adversary techniques to MITRE ATT&CK and producing post-incident lessons-learned documentation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed Azure Active Directory (AD) identity and access provisioning, implementing Conditional Access policies and MFA for cloud platform users in a FinTech SaaS environment.
- Maintained endpoint security tooling, patch management, and vulnerability assessment processes, supporting security operations across Windows and macOS fleets.
- Analysed security logs and events, supporting incident detection and root cause investigation using cloud-hosted logging and monitoring capabilities.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for routine security and operations tasks, reducing manual effort across identity provisioning and compliance reporting workflows.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM from architecture to full operation at UAL, integrating 10+ data connectors and building a library of KQL detection rules and SOAR playbooks.
- Operationalised Microsoft Defender XDR across an 8,000-user estate, consolidating endpoint, identity, and email telemetry into a unified security operations capability.
- Developed threat-hunting programmes in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon using MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hypotheses, uncovering low-and-slow persistence threats that automated alerting had missed.
- Reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) by automating high-volume, low-complexity alert triage through Sentinel SOAR playbooks.

- Mentored junior security analysts in KQL query development, SIEM use-case design, and incident investigation methodology, building team capability and reducing senior escalation load.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)